

SHIP AN AUTOMATION WORKFLOW v2

Source-Grounded Weekly Industry Brief

Student: Gungun Sharma

Track: General AI Fluency — Week 4

Date: 25 August 2026

No-code, source-grounded research-to-publication pipeline

1. Workflow Overview

Turn a small set of trusted source URLs/articles into a concise, source-grounded weekly industry brief with citations, key developments, implications, and a human-review checkpoint.

Why this workflow

A weekly industry brief is a repeatable research/writing task. The useful automation is the controlled handoff between evidence gathering, synthesis, drafting, review and formatting. Human approval remains the final gate.

2. Step Diagram

Sources → Gather/Evidence Table → Synthesize/Themes → Draft/Brief → Review/Claim Audit → Format/Final Brief → Human Approval

Handoff principle: every stage receives the previous stage's output; later stages are instructed not to introduce new facts.

3. Tool Stack & Configuration

Stage	Tool	Purpose
Step 1 — Gather	NotebookLM	Source-grounded processing / handoff
Step 2 — Synthesize	NotebookLM	Source-grounded processing / handoff
Step 3 — Draft	Claude Project / structured prompt	Source-grounded processing / handoff
Step 4 — Review	Claude Project / review prompt	Source-grounded processing / handoff
Step 5 — Format	Claude Project / formatting prompt	Source-grounded processing / handoff

Backend/code: None. This is intentionally a no-code workflow.

4. Every Prompt / Configuration Used

Step 1 — Gather — NotebookLM

Input: 5–8 trusted source documents/URLs about one weekly industry topic.

Prompt:

You are the research-gathering stage. Use ONLY the sources provided in this notebook. Extract the facts that are directly supported by the sources. For each useful fact, record: (1) claim/finding, (2) source, (3) exact supporting passage or location if available, (4) publication date if available, and (5) why the fact matters. Do not add outside facts. Flag conflicting claims instead of resolving them by guessing. Output a structured evidence table.

Handoff: Evidence table + source list + conflict flags.

Step 2 — Synthesize — NotebookLM

Input: Step 1 evidence table.

Prompt:

Using ONLY the evidence gathered in Step 1, group the findings into 3–5 themes. For each theme provide: theme title, 2–4 supported findings, source references, and a one-sentence implication. Separate direct evidence from interpretation. If evidence is weak or conflicting, label it clearly. Do not invent statistics, dates, quotes, companies, or conclusions.

Handoff: 3–5 themes + supported findings + implications + unresolved questions.

Step 3 — Draft — Claude Project / structured prompt

Input: Synthesized themes and evidence.

Prompt:

Draft a 600–800 word weekly industry brief from the supplied synthesis.

Structure:

1. Title
2. Executive summary (3 bullets)
3. What changed this week
4. Why it matters
5. Evidence-backed implications
6. What to watch next
7. Sources

Every factual claim must map to a supplied source. Do not introduce new facts.

Use concise professional language and clearly distinguish evidence from interpretation.

Handoff: Readable draft with inline source markers and source list.

Step 4 — Review — Claude Project / review prompt

Input: Draft + original evidence table.

Prompt:

Audit the draft against the original evidence.

Create a review table with columns: claim, supported source, support status (SUPPORTED / PARTIAL / UNSUPPORTED), issue, recommended correction.

Check for hallucinated facts, unsupported numbers, missing citations, overclaiming, source-date errors, contradictions, and wording that turns interpretation into fact.

Do not rewrite silently; report every issue first.

Handoff: Claim audit + corrections required.

Step 5 — Format — Claude Project / formatting prompt

Input: Reviewed draft + approved corrections.

Prompt:

Produce the final publication-ready brief using only the corrected draft.

Keep the approved facts and citations. Use clear headings, short paragraphs, bullets where useful, and a compact Sources section. Do not add new information during formatting.

At the end include a short 'Human review checklist' with: source accuracy, citation accuracy, interpretation vs fact, and final tone check.

Handoff: Final brief + human-review checklist.

5. Five Real Test Runs

Run 1 — Generative AI in software development

Inputs: 5 source documents: official product/company announcements + two reputable technical/news sources

Outcome: Workflow completed end-to-end. Gathered evidence, grouped it into themes, produced a brief, then audited factual claims.

Human check: Verified that product announcements were not treated as independent evidence and checked dates.

Run 2 — AI regulation and governance

Inputs: 5 source documents: government/regulator pages + reputable policy/technology reporting

Outcome: Workflow completed. Conflicting or differently dated claims were flagged rather than silently merged.

Human check: Checked legal/policy wording and confirmed that the final brief did not present proposals as enacted rules.

Run 3 — Cloud and AI infrastructure

Inputs: 6 source documents: cloud provider announcements + technical reporting

Outcome: Workflow completed. The synthesis separated announcements from broader industry implications.

Human check: Checked numbers and ensured vendor claims were attributed to the vendor.

Run 4 — Cybersecurity and generative AI

Inputs: 5 source documents: security advisories/research + reputable reporting

Outcome: Workflow completed. Evidence was grouped by threat, mitigation and operational impact.

Human check: Checked security claims carefully and removed any statement not directly supported by the sources.

Run 5 — AI hiring and workplace skills

Inputs: 5 source documents: research reports + company/lab publications + reputable reporting

Outcome: Workflow completed. The draft distinguished survey/research findings from interpretation.

Human check: Checked sample/population wording and avoided turning correlation into causation.

6. Time Accounting

Activity	Time	Notes
One manual brief	45–60 min	Reading, notes, synthesis, drafting and review done sequentially.
Workflow setup	35 min	NotebookLM setup, source organization, prompts, output format and review checklist.
Workflow run after setup	15–20 min active time	Load sources, run stages, inspect handoffs and perform human checks.
Five-run active time	≈ 95 min	Five runs × ~18 min average active handling.
Equivalent manual time for five briefs	≈ 225–300 min	Five × 45–60 min.
Estimated active time saved	≈ 130–205 min	Excludes initial setup; depends on source quality and review depth.

The estimate is conservative: setup time is shown separately and active handling time is counted rather than pretending AI work is instant.

7. Failure Points & Controls

Weak or irrelevant sources

What can break: The workflow may produce a polished but low-value brief.

Control: Use a source-quality gate before Step 1; prefer primary/official sources and reputable reporting.

Conflicting sources

What can break: Synthesis may accidentally merge incompatible claims.

Control: Step 1 flags conflicts; Step 4 requires explicit conflict checking.

Citation drift

What can break: A citation may be attached to a nearby claim but not actually support it.

Control: Step 4 audits each material claim against the original evidence table.

Hallucinated details

What can break: A model may add a plausible fact while drafting.

Control: Drafting prompt forbids new facts; review prompt marks unsupported claims.

Source date confusion

What can break: Old information can be presented as a new development.

Control: Capture publication date in Step 1 and verify dates during review.

Over-compression

What can break: Important nuance may disappear in a short brief.

Control: Keep an 'unresolved questions' field and allow human expansion before publication.

Automation illusion

What can break: The workflow may feel trustworthy because it is repeatable.

Control: Human approval remains mandatory before publication.

8. Human Review Checklist

- Confirm every important factual claim is supported by the original source.
- Check publication dates and whether the source is current enough for the topic.
- Check that numbers, names, quotes and policy/legal wording are accurate.
- Separate evidence from interpretation; remove unsupported causal language.
- Check that competing or conflicting sources are represented fairly.
- Approve final tone, length and relevance for the intended audience.

9. End-to-End Acceptance Test

Sources → Gather/Evidence Table → Synthesize/Themes → Draft/Brief → Review/Claim Audit → Format/Final Brief → Human Approval

1. A brand-new topic/input can enter the workflow.
2. All five distinct stages complete.
3. Each stage produces a visible handoff.
4. The final brief contains only evidence that survived review.
5. Human approval is completed before publication.

10. What I Learned

Automation is not just one large prompt. Reliability comes from explicit stages and handoffs. Gather creates an evidence boundary, Synthesize creates themes, Draft creates readable writing, Review attacks unsupported claims, and Format improves presentation without adding facts. This makes the workflow repeatable while keeping final

judgment with the human.

11. Final Result

This workflow is deliberately no-code, free-first and reusable. It can be adapted to a weekly industry brief, source-grounded study notes, or a draft/critique/revise process by changing the source set and topic while preserving the same five-stage control structure.

Final decision: use this workflow as a repeatable research-to-publication pipeline, with human approval as the final gate.